College Bound

ISSUES & TRENDS FOR THE COLLEGE ADMISSIONS ADVISOR

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Admissions Watch

New Recruitment Methods Impact Fall Admissions

Bates C. Is Test Optional, But Many Students Still Submit Test Scores. Bates C. in Maine received 5,356 first-year applications and posted an admissions rate of nearly 23 percent. About 24 percent of the Class of 2020 is composed of U.S. students of color. And 60 percent of the new class includes non-native New Englanders. About 53 percent is female and 12 percent of the class is the first in their family to attend a four-year college. Despite Bates' test optional policy, 51 percent of applicants submitted either ACT or SAT scores. Institutional need-based aid went to 42 percent of the new class, according Leigh Weisenburger, dean of admission and financial aid.

Bethel C. Reevaluating Recruitment Methods. Bethel C. in Kansas recruited a new class of 460 students, down 12 percent from last year. "We didn't reach the number we had set as a goal," said Andy Johnson, vice president for admissions. "We're not happy about that, but we are evaluating our methods, looking for ways to do a better job of making sure students know Bethel is a great place to get an education."

Brown Freezes Undergrad Enrollment. After expanding undergraduate enrollment for a decade, Brown U. announced it is making "historic changes to the university's budget and business model." The new plan calls for freezing undergraduate admission at 1,650 students and growing the university's graduate programs "in a targeted and incremental way." Undergraduate enrollment will be solidified at 6,848 students. The changes result from a decade of financial pressure resulting from dramatic increases in undergraduate enrollment. Brown "relies more heavily on tuition and fees than most of its peers," said Provost Richard Locke.

What Determines How C. Of New Jersey Transfer Students Will Fare? The C. of New Jersey received 400 transfer applications for this fall and accepted about 180. "We believe that the transcript can most accurately tell us how well they will fare in an academic setting," Kaitlin West, admission counselor, told *The Signal*. The college also looks for students with strong standardized test scores, unless they are applying with more than 45 credits.

Delta C. Up 8 Percent. Delta C. in Michigan welcomed 2,863 new students this fall, up 8 percent over last year. Some 938 high school students are also taking dual enrollment classes, the most ever." Zachary Ward, director of admissions and recruitment, said. "Delta is supporting the growing needs of local businesses with graduates in a variety of health, business, computer technologies and skilled trade fields."

DePaul's Record. This year, DePaul U. in Chicago attracted a record number of applications and enrolled 2,459 new freshman. The average high school GPA of new students was 3.55, the average ACT score was 25.3. The Class of 2020 is among DePaul's most diverse, with students of color comprising 38 percent of the class, first-generation students 32 percent and out-of-state students 40 percent.

Concerns about the continued funding of Illinois' MAP grant program for low-income students and increased tuition discounting by

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International Affairs

REUTERS news service sent ripples of concern through counseling and admissions offices late October with its report on Dipont Education Management Group, an Australian-based company with offices in China that helps Chinese students apply to U.S. colleges. In addition, at least 20 prominent colleges and universities participated in summer workshops in Beijing, but the report accused some participants of accepting ethically-questionable reimbursements. It also charged that Dipont employees wrote some application essays for weak students, altered recommendations and changed grades to help Chinese students gain admission to U.S. colleges. See, www.reuters.com for complete story.

NACAC Acts On Overseas Agents. Meanwhile, with more and more international students being recruited by agents, the National Association for College Admission Counseling added two best practices at its annual meeting to its Statement of Principles of Good Practice. Colleges that use agents should "require those representatives to disclose to their student clients all institutions who are compensating them." Also, in their promotional materials for international students, "institutions should offer to verify whether they have authorized any third party agents to represent them and indicate how students may request this verification."

Credentialing Chinese Students. And one task set for the U. of Southern California's new Center for Enrollment Research, Policy and

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NEW RECRUITMENT
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competitors were important factors affecting the outcome, David Kalsbeek, senior vice president of enrollment management and marketing, said. He added, "We can no longer expect the levels of significant annual growth in enrollment and revenue that we've known in the past…. We have a strong brand and a wide portfolio of academic programs, but our focus on improving the experience and outcomes our students realize for their tuition dollars must be unrelenting."

Fort Lewis Raises The Bar. Fort Lewis C. in Colorado recruited its best academically prepared class in school history, but enrollment is down 3.3 percent. Last year, the school enrolled 4,065 students; this fall 3,595 students. More than a third of the new class posted a 3.5 or higher GPA in high school.

"Increasing our admissions standards led us to deny many students who would have been admitted in the past," said FLC spokesman Mitch Davis. "We're looking ahead to state changes in admissions standards in 2019, and we're phasing in those changes over time. That might mean challenging enrollment for the next few years."

Kansas Offers Automatic Admission. The U. of Kansas received 14,560 applications for this fall, admitted 13,526 and enrolled 4,233. Kansas has automatic admissions standards, which the school says are the toughest of any state university in the country, and admits students with a 3.0 high school GPA, 1090 on the SAT or 24 ACT, or a 3.25 GPA and ACT score of 21.

Students who don't meet those standards are reviewed by a special committee. Statistics show that students in this last group have about an 8 percent likelihood of graduating. "Our goal is never to ratchet up these standards to deny admissions," Matt Melvin, KU's vice provost for enrollment management, told LJWorld.com. "But access without success is access to nothing."

Lehigh Increases Diversity. One quarter of all students enrolled at Lehigh U. in Pennsylvania are minority students, an all-time high. "Lehigh has made the conscious decision to proactively and intentionally recruit top talent across the country from diverse backgrounds," wrote *The Brown and White,* Lehigh's student newspaper. "Lehigh should be a representation of the world," Henry Odi, vice provost for academic diversity, told the paper. "Not just the country, but the world."

Mercyhurst U. Creates A Larger Class. This fall, 800 first-year students enrolled in Mercyhurst U. in Erie, Pennsylvania, the most in school history. One hundred of them brought perfect 4.0 high school GPAs.

Miami By Thirds. New students at the U. of Miami show the school is doing things by thirds. A third of the new class led male or female athletic teams. A third held leadership positions in performing arts. And another third were presidents of an organization. Additionally, 68 percent speak two or more languages, while 80 percent participated in community service.

Overall, Miami received 32,511 applications, admitted 12,210 and enrolled 2,144 new students. This year's Early Action and Early Decision deadline is November 1, Karen Long, assistant vice president of undergraduate admissions and marketing, told *The Miami Hurricane*.

Monmouth Attracts Out-Of-State Students. After increasing admissions standards two years ago, out-of-state applications to Monmouth C. in Illinois are up 15 percent this year. "Given the significant challenges presented by the state of Illinois' inability to pass a budget and fund the MAP grant, which caused significant numbers of college-bound Illinois residents to leave the state this year, we're pleased with the fact that we enrolled more new students this year than last," Nick Spaeth, vice president of admission, told *The Courier*.

NYU Abu Dhabi. New York U.'s Abu Dhabi campus received 11,000 applications for this fall, but admitted only 402 students for a 4 percent admit rate. It then matriculated 323 students in the Class of 2020. The new class includes students from 76 different countries. The median composite ACT score was 33. And 92 percent of the student body speak two or more languages, while 42 percent speak three or more. Currently, NYU Abu Dhabi enrolls 1,050 students, 54 percent of whom are female.

Golden "Domers" Travel Far. The U. of Notre Dame welcomed 2,048 new students who were chosen from a pool of 19,505 applicants. New students traveled an average 750 miles to ND in South Bend, Indiana, from 1,361 high schools and 47 nations. They speak 57 different languages. "During their years at Notre Dame, we will do our best to guide our students toward a deeper personal development leading them towards a greater sense of wisdom," said Don Bishop, associate vice president of undergraduate enrollment.

Southwestern Students Hail From 19 States. A full 73 percent of the Class of 2020 at Southwestern U. in Texas ranked in the top 25 percent of their high school graduating class, and 36 percent was in the top 10 percent. The incoming average SAT score was 1171, the ACT was 25.7. Underrepresented students comprise 39 percent of the new class and 15 percent are first-generation students. Altogether, students hail from 19 states in seven countries. Additionally, 82 percent of the new class received merit scholarships of $17,000 or more. Southwestern's total student population is 1,489 students.

SUNY Oswego Students Are From 18 Nations. The State U. of New York at Oswego enrolled nearly 300 freshmen from New York City, six from Washington D.C. and scores of students from 14 other states and 18 countries for a total of 1,445 freshmen. Over a third of them represent diverse cultures. And there's been a 70 percent increase over the past decade in the number of first-year students pursuing STEM disciplines.

"We are enrolling so many more students from farther away that we don't have the commuters we did decades ago," said Dan Griffin, admissions director.

Wartburg Down Four Percent. Overall enrollment dipped at Wartburg C. in Iowa by 4 percent last fall to 1,482 students. Still, Wartburg welcomed 479 new students, 72 more than last year. High school students recruited by the college who show interest can receive as many as 150-170 promotional pieces through the mail. As a result, between 2,500-3,000 people visit the college each year.

"By birth rates, we've entered a number of years now where high school graduating classes are getting smaller," Edith Waldstein, vice president for enrollment management, told the *Wartburg Circuit*.

Washington U. Uses Student Ambassadors. Washington U. in St. Louis is using student ambassadors to go into high schools and reach out to low-income African American and Latino students, according to Julie Shimabukuro, director of admissions.

As a result, the Class of 2020 ranks near the top in terms of racial and socioeconomic diversity. Some 12 percent of the freshman class is African-American, while 9 percent is Latino or Latina. Additionally, 13 percent of freshmen are eligible for Pell Grants.

Wilson's Largest Student Body. Wilson C. in Chambersburg, Pennsylvania, enrolled 1,098 students this fall, the largest student body in its 147-year history as a liberal arts school. It also matriculated its largest incoming class since 1967. Wilson's fastest-growing enrollment remains graduate studies, with 350 students enrolled across seven Master's degree programs, a 50 percent increase over Fall 2014. Wilson's students come from 18 states and 16 foreign countries. One reason is that Wilson has held tuition steady without an increase over the past six years.

Yale's Yield Up. Yale U. posted a 70.5 percent yield, one point higher than last year. Minority students make up 43 percent of the class, including 11 percent African American students. ■

The Counselor's Corner

Financial Affairs

WHILE THE MAIN FINANCIAL NEWS was about the implications of the new FAFSA October 1 deadline, some colleges announced new policies and programs impacting student financial affairs at their own institutions.

Luther's Scholarships Soar. Since 2006, when the percent of revenues expended for scholarships and grants was 27 percent, Luther C. in Iowa has steadily increased that amount to nearly 37 percent in the 2015-16 academic year. In 2016-17, Luther will award $46 million in scholarships. "Every year, the scholarships are [used as a recruitment tool] and every college does it," said Scot Schaeffer, vice president for enrollment management, told the student newspaper. "That's how you get students, you give out merit-based scholarships."

Portland State "Free." Portland State U. in Oregon is making its four-year degree "free" for thousands of eligible students. Called "Four Years Free," the program combines federal and state grants with institutional waivers to guarantee free tuition and fees for low-income students. Freshmen who have a 3.4 high school GPA and who are eligible for federal Pell Grants can apply to the PSU program immediately. Currently, 38 percent of PSU's 38,000 students are Pell eligible. About 8,500 total students will ultimately take advantage of the program. Oregon State U. has a similar program that serves about 3,000 students.

Trinity Waives First-Generation Application Fees. Trinity C. in Hartford, Connecticut, announced it will waive the $65 application fee for first-generation undergraduate applicants. Angel Perez, Trinity's vice president for enrollment and student success, told the *Trinity Tripod* that the change was inspired, in part, by Michelle Obama's "Reach Higher" initiative. Trinity is engaged in an "effort to tear down a barrier between first-generation students and educational opportunities."

Access Yale. Yale U.'s two-year fundraising initiative for financial aid, "Access Yale," has officially ended after raising $285 million. "No investment is more foundational than our commitment to financial aid," said president Peter Salovey. Yale is only one of 66 colleges and universities to offer need-blind financial aid for U.S. citizens. In 2001, Yale extended its need-blind financial aid policy to international students. It is only one of seven U.S. colleges and universities with that policy.

Financial Aid Gap. According to a recent *Money* magazine report, the average college only provides enough aid to meet 66 percent of students' financial needs. The largest financial aid gaps fall upon those who need the most help. Students from families earning between $30,000 and $65,000 a year end up needing an average extra $9,400. But the average financial aid gap for families earning more than $105,000 is only about $3,500.

Money found that only 150 of the nation's public and private four-year colleges "say it is their policy to provide enough grants to meet at least 90 percent of the 'demonstrated financial need' of undergraduates."

Students from families earning less than $48,000 a year should consult *Money's* free Affordable College Finder at www.money.com. Also, see Collegedata.com and the federal College Navigator.

P.S. Income Down, But Tuition Soars. Between 2000 and 2014, the median American household income dropped by 7 percent. But tuition and fees at public colleges in America rose 80 percent.

SCHOLARSHIP SCOOPS

Frederick Douglass Scholarship. Hillsdale C. in Michigan, a conservative liberal arts college, has established a Frederick Douglass Scholarship for first-generation students. Applicants must come from a family with a household income under $41,000 and from an economically-disadvantaged school district.

"Our scholarship offerings are impressive," said Zach Miller, senior director of admissions. "Most importantly, if a student is a good academic fit and desires a classic good liberal arts education, then we will help as best we can to make a financial solution."

ND's Latino Scholars Program. The U. of Notre Dame launched a Latino Scholars Program that will award merit-based scholarships of $25,000 per year for four years, plus $5,000 per summer for internships, conferences and travel. The scholarship was created by the Institute for Latino Studies. Selection is made through the admissions process.

Arizona Women in Science. Female students in Arizona who plan to pursue careers in engineering, medicine or natural sciences can now apply for the Dr. Patti Flint Women in Science Scholarship. See www.pattiflintmd.com/dr-flint-scholarship .

Benedictine STEM Support. Benedictine U. outside Chicago received two $1 million gifts from benefactors with ties to Telllabs that will go to scholarships supporting students seeking science degrees.

Kenyon Receives $12 Million for Scholarships. Kenyon C. in Ohio recently received a $12 million gift. "That's roughly 5 percent of our endowment, so one single gift is a huge impact," said Sean Decatur, president. Students from New Hampshire and those involved in the fine arts will receive preference for the scholarship funds. ■

COUNSELOR'S BOOKSHELF

The K&W Guide to Colleges for Students with Learning Differences, 13th edition; The Princeton Review; ISBN: 978-1-101-92 038-1; $31.99.

Paying For College Without Going Broke, 2017 Edition; The Princeton Review; ISBN: 978-1-101-92042-8; $21.99.

"Keep the Damned Women Out": The Struggle for Coeducation by Nancy Weiss Malkiel; Princeton University Press; ISBN: 978-0-691-17299-6; $35.

Game of Loans: The Rhetoric and Reality of Student Debt by Beth Akers and Matthew Chingos; Princeton University Press; ISBN: 978-0-691-16715-2; $26.95.

Envisioning the Faculty for the 21st Century: Moving to a Mission-Oriented and Learner-Centered Model by Adrianna Kezar and Daniel Maxey, Rutgers University Press, ISBN: 10-0813581001;$49.95.

What Universities Can Be: A New Model for Preparing Students for Active Concerned Citizenship and Ethical Leadership by Robert J. Sternberg, Cornell University Press, ISBN: 10-080145378X; $29.95. ■

CURRICULUM CAPSULES

Chemical Engineering. Beginning next fall, students at the U. of Texas at San Antonio will be able to major in chemical engineering. Students will have the option to specialize in one of five tracks: bioengineering, energy, environmental, materials or technology management.

According to the Bureau of Labor Statistics, Texas and the Gulf region are among the biggest employers of chemical engineers, with an average salary of about $120,000. "A chemical engineering program helps tie together all of our existing programs," said JoAnn Browning, dean, adding that it is the school's mission to fill critical workforce needs.

Behavioral Economics. Wagner C. on Staten Island in New York City is offering a major in the new field of behavioral economics. "Several years in the making, the new major is an interdisciplinary major that draws equally from Wagner's offerings in economics and psychology to look at how people make economic decisions." Wagner believes that the program is the first of its kind in the nation.

Disability Studies. New York U. is offering a new minor in disability studies "intended to educate students about the historical, social and legal circumstances that shape the experience of disability." The new NYU undergraduate minor incorporates courses across the humanities, social sciences, communication, education, engineering, medical ethics and the arts.

Human Resource Management. The U. of Birmingham's School of Business now offers a B.S. degree in human resource management. The curriculum covers issues of human resources and employee relations, including compensation, recruiting/staffing, employment law, leadership and workforce diversity. ■

NEWS YOU CAN USE

Mozart And The PSAT. Mozart and other classical music are the most popular test-prep music used by teens preparing for the PSAT, according to a Kapan Test Prep survey. But the second choice was "no music." To fuel themselves, Kapan found teens turn to popcorn, chips, chocolate, pizza and pretzels. But experts warn against using sugary snacks before or during a real test because they can cause blood glucose levels to fluctuate, which can result in lethargy, irritability and fatigue. Instead, test-takers should opt for high-protein snacks.

Underemployed Graduates. Over 44 percent of recent college graduates are underemployed and often work in a job that doesn't require a college degree. That is the conclusion of the New York Federal Reserve's most recent study of people ages 22 to 27. The New York Fed found that the Great Recession has had lingering effects especially among recent college grads.

The worst year was 2011, when almost half of new college graduates had to settle for jobs that did not require degrees. About 19 percent of recent grads ended up in minimum wage jobs. Women fared the worst and ended up with the lowest scale, low-paid jobs. Men were able to get better paying jobs based upon physical strength.

Those with technical skills did the best. "Those with majors in Liberal Arts and General Business are two to three times more likely to be underemployed than those with engineering and nursing majors," the report said. The five majors with the poorest employment records are criminal justice, performing arts, leisure and hospitality, anthropology and art history.

The prospect for students who are still in college is not particularly great either. The Fed said that since 2000, opportunity has weakened for those with college degrees. One reason seems to be that the surge in the number of jobs around 2000 was the result of changes in technology and was probably a one-time opportunity phenomenon. "As the technology revolution reached maturity, demand for cognitive skills fell accordingly," the report said. Those without a college degree have been displaced by their better educated peers.

Endowments Tax Protected? Billions of dollars in university endowments are shielded from taxation, presumably to promote the common good of educating future citizens and creating new knowledge that benefits society. But with tuitions still soaring and extravagant spending on administrative salaries, luxurious buildings and spectacular athletics facilities, Congress is debating whether or not larger percentages of those endowments should be going to alleviating student costs and debt. ■

More Students Submit Portfolios

Colleges are looking for new dimensions of merit, becoming test-score optional and are in an information economy that increasingly values competencies above all else. So "more and more schools are turning to portfolios to help admissions officers make the best decisions," Chris Jagers, CEO of Learning Machine, told a panel called "Accepting Portfolios for Admission: Lessons from Early Adopters" at NACAC's annual meeting.

"If you're already running art and music portfolios, you're just running a portfolio system for a different domain of creative expression," said Chris Peterson, assistant director of admissions at MIT. "Bringing that process over into the technical domain has been super useful for us as admissions officers."

"Portfolios are a reminder that imagination is not simply an add-on, but in fact constitutive of any professional trajectory," said Natalie Smolenski of Learning Machine Research. "They are also part and parcel of the new media economy where you have generations that have grown up online who have been self-presenting, who have been self-curating, since childhood…. All we need to do is create a place for that to land and convert into opportunity." ■

INTERNATIONAL AFFAIRS

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Practice is to create "verifiable credentials" for Chinese applicants to U.S. colleges. Ten other colleges are participating in exploratory meetings, according to BusinessInsider.com.

International Student Bubble? At the same time, one session at the recent NACAC meeting discussed whether or not there is an international student bubble. A survey of 214 high school counselors based outside of the U.S. saw an increase in the number of traditionally U.S.-bound students considering non-U.S. options.

The reasons: costs, guns and safety, the political environment and visa problems. The counselors also cited the difficulty of applying to U.S. colleges, completing standardized tests and elaborate college applications. Also, other nations with economic problems, such as Saudi Arabia and Brazil, are cutting scholarships for students to study in the United States. And, many U.S. universities have opened branch campuses around the world.

However, the overall number of international students studying in the U.S. has increased greatly over the past 20 years, primarily because of the surge of students from China. In 1995, only 39,613 Chinese students were studying in the U.S. Last year, that number was 304,040. ■

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